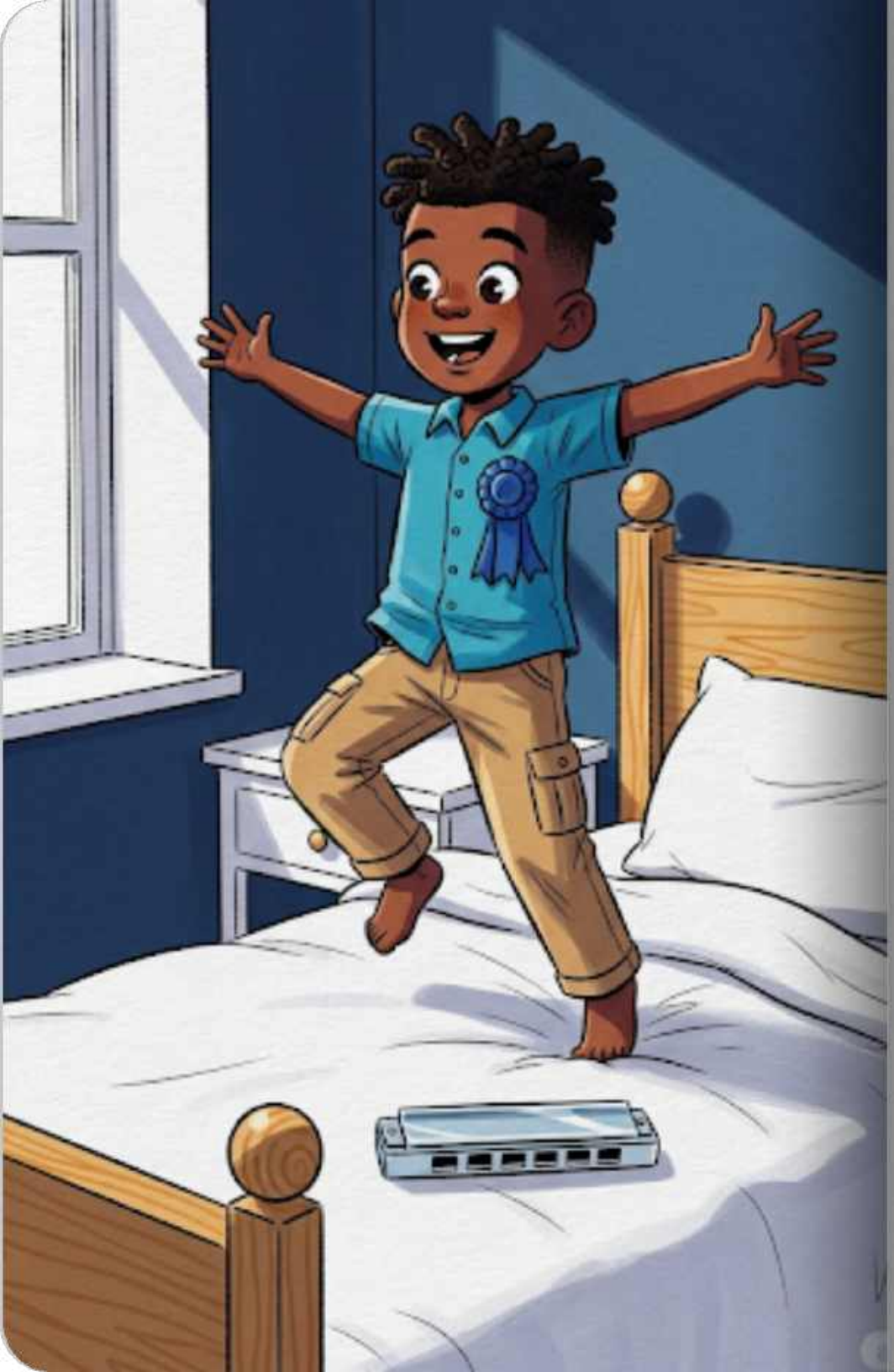
Arlo and the Blue Anchor

By Kshipra



The Talent Show was over, and Arlo was finally home in his bedroom. He had won a small blue ribbon, but his brain felt like it was still on stage. He was bouncing on his mattress, his legs full of "zips" and "zaps." "That was amazing!" he

Twitch was even more wired. The little purple creature was zooming in circles around Arlo's head, his long ears trailing behind him like streamers. "Did you hear the clapping?!" Twitch squeaked. "What if we go on tour? What if we

Arlo tried to lie still, but his heart was still thumping "Thump-thump! Thump-thump!" It wasn't the scary thump from before the show; it was a loud, noisy thump that kept him awake. Twitch started jumping on Arlo's

Just then, a soft, teal glow appeared on the windowsill. A new creature sat there, round and smooth like a polished river stone. He had short, velvety fur and tiny, shimmering wings that didn't flap—they just drifted. This was Hum,

Hum drifted off the windowsill and landed gently on Arlo's chest. He didn't say anything at first. He just sat there, heavy and warm. Arlo felt the weight of the little creature, and suddenly, his racing heart began to slow down just a tiny bit.

Twitch zoomed down, ready to poke the newcomer. "Hey! Who are you? We're busy being excited!" Twitch poked Hum's round belly. Instead of popping or jumping, Hum simply rippled like a quiet pond. He let out a low, steady

Hum looked at Arlo. "Imagine you are a boat," Hum said in a voice as smooth as honey. "The talent show was a big, exciting storm. But every boat needs an anchor so it doesn't drift away." Hum showed Arlo how to

Arlo followed Hum's lead. With every breath, the "zips" and "zaps" in his legs started to fade. He felt heavy, like he was sinking into a soft cloud. "I can still feel the happy feelings," Arlo realized, "but they aren't shouting

The room was silent and still. The blue ribbon sat on the nightstand, and the silver harmonica was tucked away. Arlo closed his eyes, feeling the gentle weight of his two friends. Fear had kept him alert, but Calmness was the one